Moreover, with the upcoming presidential elections, Biden will not risk antagonizing part of the Jewish community. Realpolitik is what it is. It is also true, regarding the Palestinian issue, that Mahmoud Abbas, the elderly Fatah leader, is far from helpful when it comes to negotiations: he seems to have chosen confrontation by referring every problem to the UN, where the Palestinians are assured of an automatic majority but where decisions are mostly rhetorical.

Israeli drone attacks inside Iran (Ispahan) and in Northern Syria are even more frequent than usual. Does it mean that a generalized war is on the horizon? In flat landscapes the horizon may be far away, so shall we say "nearby"?

Wednesday, February 1

Khan al-Ahmar, the Bedouin hamlet in the south of Jerusalem, is a good reality test when it comes to distinguishing between declarations and policies. As I mentioned, some years ago the Supreme Court ordered the dismantlement of the village. Since then, it became a right-wing mantra that Khan al-Ahmar had to be pulled down, but international pressure led to postponements. Of course, Ben-Gvir and Smotrich demanded quick action but, lo and behold, for the ninth time, the government, in which they are ministers, has asked the Supreme Court to allow the postponement of its decision.

From the serious to the ridiculous: Lapid and Gantz, the two main figures of the previous government, have lost all credibility as leaders of the opposition, not least because of their acute rivalry. In the meantime, somebody unknown to the public up to now, the chairman of the Israel Bar Association, Avi Himi, has drawn increasing admiration and was mentioned as a potential head of the opposition, thanks to his cogent and energetic